

Individual Instructor Report Spring 2025 Version A for STA 235 - DATA SCI FOR BUSINESS APPLCTNS (05545) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Spring 2025**

Courses Audience: **56**

Responses Received: **53**

Response Ratio: **94.6%**

Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

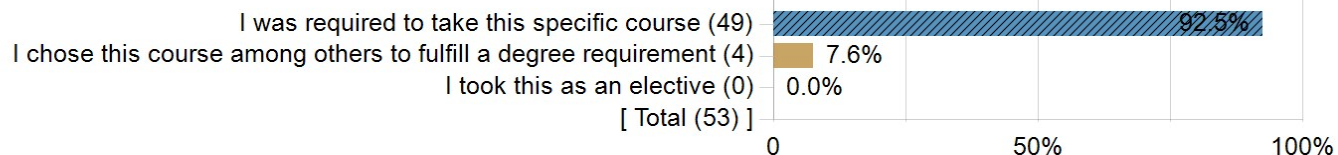
The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

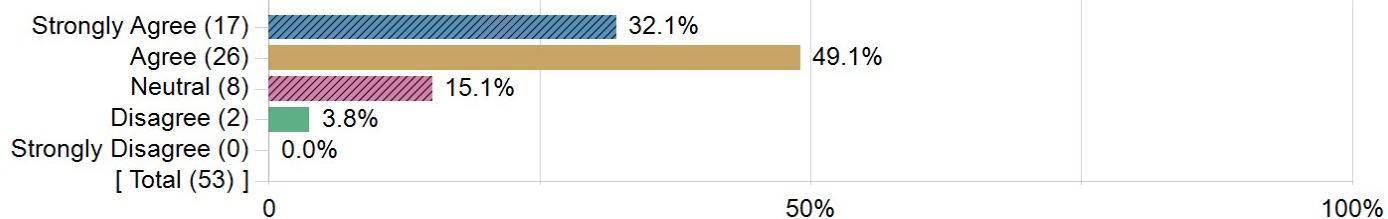
Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

Course Questions

Why did you take this course?



During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.



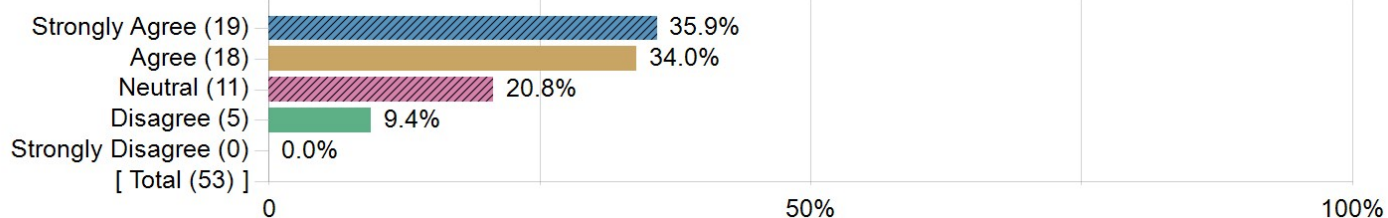
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.09

The course was well organized.



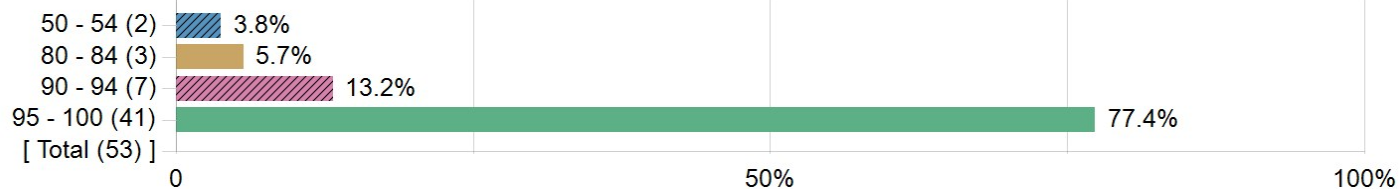
Statistics

Value

Mean

3.96

Overall, approximately what percentage of the course meetings did you attend or complete (online, in person, or asynchronously)?



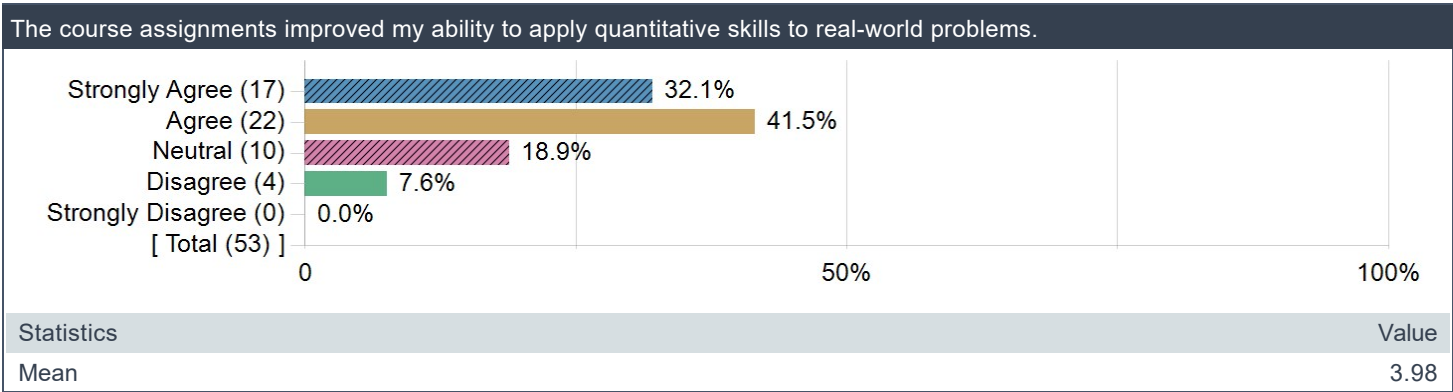
Statistics

Value

Mean

95.15

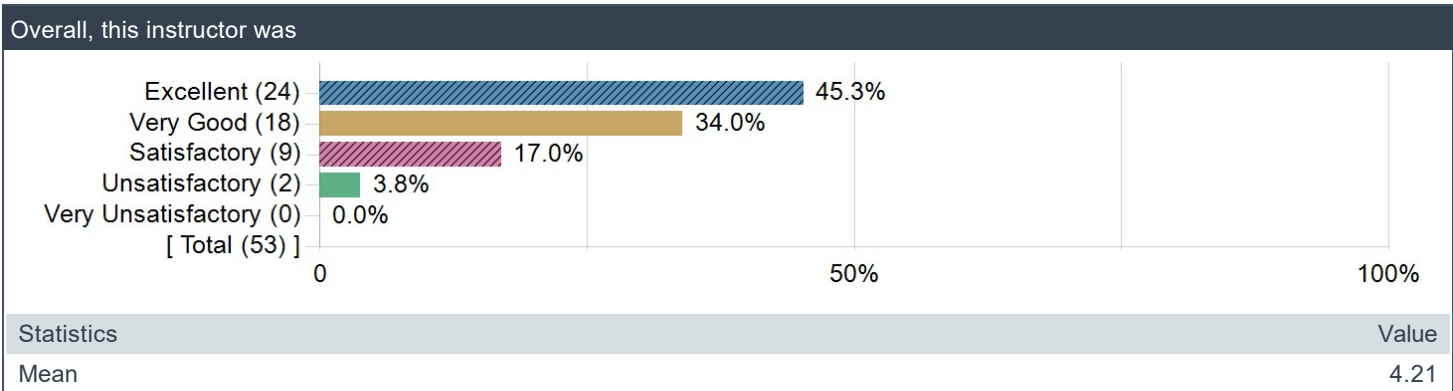
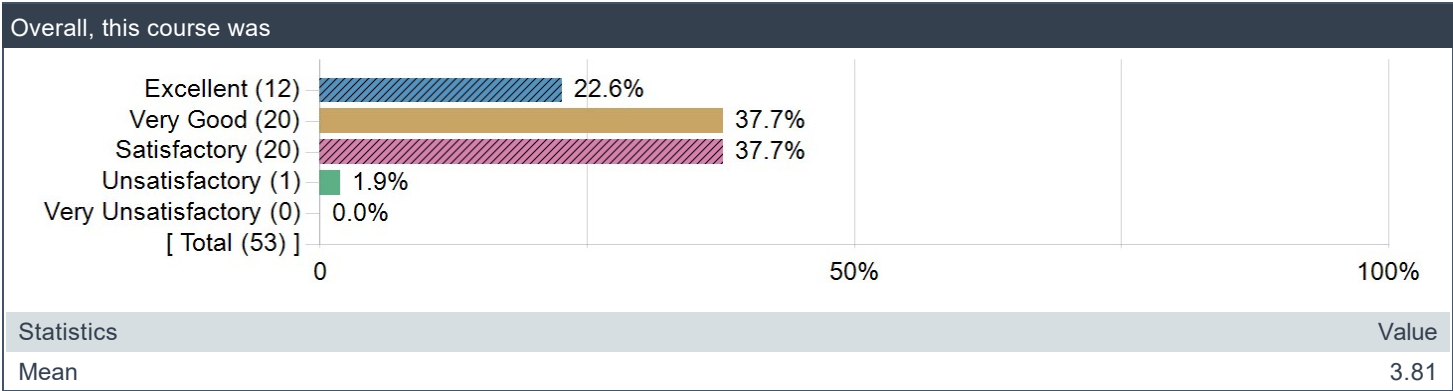
The course assignments improved my ability to apply quantitative skills to real-world problems. (Flag Question)



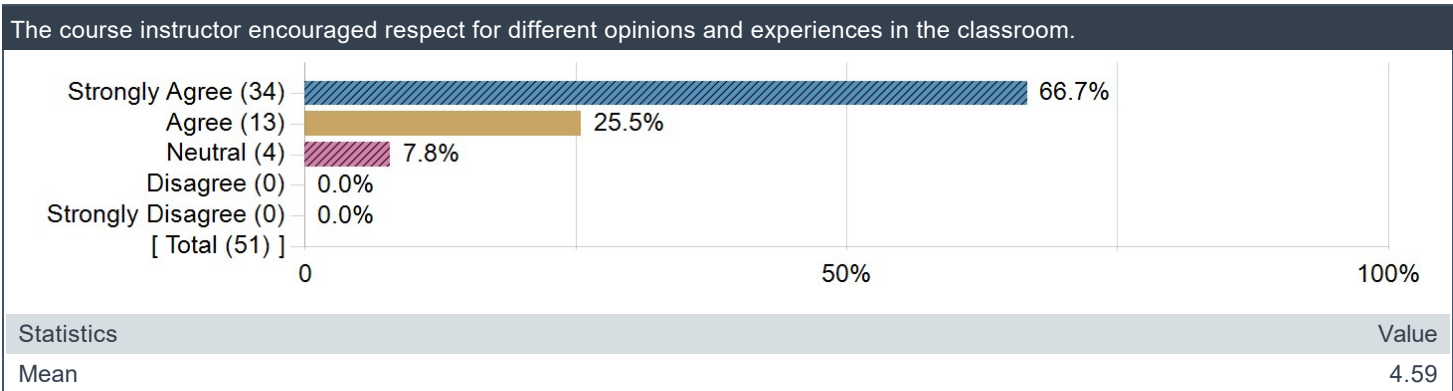
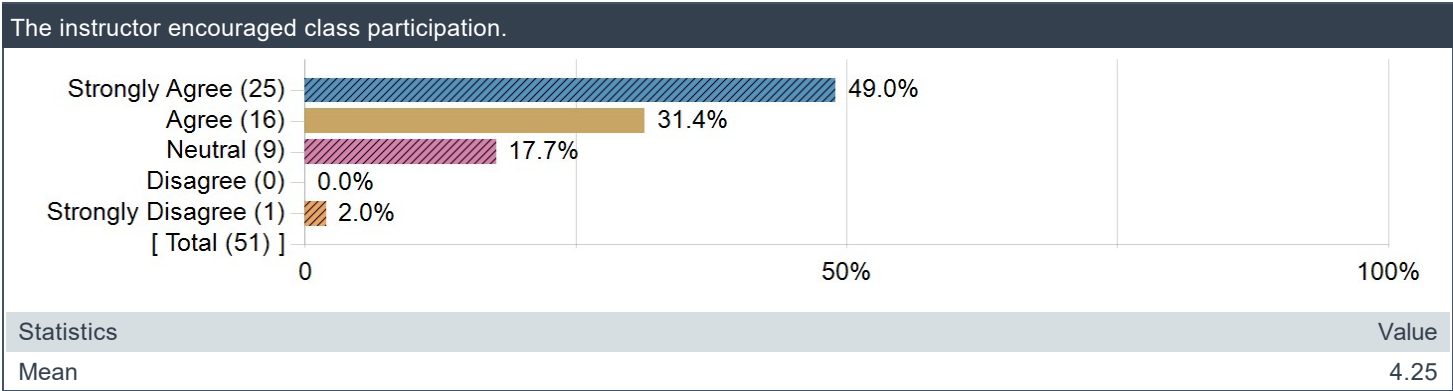
Instructor Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	50.9%	41.5%	7.5%	0.0%	0.0%	53	4.43
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	66.0%	24.5%	9.4%	0.0%	0.0%	53	4.57
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	49.1%	35.8%	13.2%	1.9%	0.0%	53	4.32
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	41.5%	30.2%	11.3%	13.2%	3.8%	53	3.92
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	45.3%	39.6%	9.4%	3.8%	1.9%	53	4.23

Overall Questions



College, School, or Unit Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
n/a
Weekly in class quizzes incentivized reading the material, homeworks were helpful and prepared me well for the exam.
Reading the slides was pretty helpful.
office hours with the professor and ta review sessions
I think that the homework was most effective in helping my learning.
His office hours were helpful and the textbook material
The practice exams, and in in class quizzes.
The weekly in class quizzes were really helpful and mimicked the exams
The posted notes and R scripts helped me to go back and reinforce concepts I may have glanced over.
I think the class recordings were effective in helping me return to rewatch lectures and enforce my learning, with the addition of the posted r-script and slides.
The lecture recordings and review sessions
Homeworks, class quizzes being re-opened, exam reviews, open-note testing
going through the class material in R was helpful
Bolfarine is a great lecturer and puts in jokes to keep students engaged
Amazing
He was a greta professor
The homeworks helped with applying what we learned in class.
he is the nicest professor i have ever had. cares about his students and the course is organized. always willing to help in office hours. easily one of the more compassionate, kindhearted people I have met at ut and has such a passion.
The in class quizzes.
I thought that the TA office hour videos were a huge help to my learning; she was truly great.
the review sessions with head TA
studying outside of class
TA Sessions
Going through R-script together
I think that the homeworks and in class assesments at the end of class were helpful!
The SI sessions were very helpful and his teaching was very engaging.
Creating R scripts and running them in class, then writing down what the results mean
The slides and readings were extremely helpful, along with the practice exams.
The lectures being recorded so I could go back and watch
I liked the weekly review sessions on Monday to review the material from the previous week.
I think going through in class assignments together really helped.
Professor Bolfarine kept the class engaged by asking questions and answering if we had any. The homeworks helped the most in my learning as we were able to practice what we learned in class.
Professor Bolfarine was always available during office hours to help students and in class he related the material to real life making it easier to understand
TA's review videos
I would say that the structure being so organized, the review sessions, along with the TAs really helped.
It was great
The most effective aspect in helping my learning for this class was the in-class quizzes, as they encouraged me to stay consistently engaged with the material and helped reinforce key concepts through regular review and practice.
Bolfarine was very understanding in providing extra support whenever needed.
I believe the professor was the most effective aspect of this course.

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
Paper test!
Figuring out the r-script for homework was challenging. I found figuring out the code more difficult than interpreting the results.
Following the class for two hours every week was really challenging. If you looked away for one minute, you would be behind in the code. I think the subject matter is fairly difficult, and I really like Prof. Bolfarine, but I enjoyed STA301 far more.
checkpoint quizzes were not always aligned with what the professor taught
The course is extremely fast paced. I would recommend including more resources and more help for students who might have taken STA 301 many semesters previously.
the check point quizzes have to go
Although the in class quizzes helped, they were sometimes difficult to keep up with.
I think the concepts in general were difficult and what could have made the class easier was working through problems more similar to that of the quizzes and homework in class.
The checkpoint quizzes I felt were challenging because it was hard to get a grasp or form an expectation of what material would be on the quiz. I would try and make the homework more indicative of the material covered on the checkpoint quizzes.
I found it most challenging to practice or reinforce my learning in topics I struggled with, perhaps if there was more review sessions or like a review help sheet to help breakdown the most important terms would be helpful.
Analyzing some code
Using R-Studio/coding during class and on assignments, but taking tests on paper in a completely different format. I felt that half of my struggle with understanding course content was due to my lack of coding knowledge, which made it extremely difficult to focus on content that would actually be tested during exams.
It was not very engaging so I had a tough time paying attention. It was also very quick, with not a lot of time if you were confused or behind.
Studying for the tests were challenging, it would be helpful if we were given more study material or practice tests or more access to past assignments
Nothing
The amount of time we have to spend each class
The lectures were way too long and we still didn't cover all the content in class. I wish we would have less topics and spend more time on the foundations of the topics to help my understanding.
it was difficult when the course material was not finished during class, as I found it hard to learn on a video sometimes.
The homework because we only had 3 attempts, which is not enough to get a deeper understanding of the problems.
I think that there was an abundance of technology issues during the course that severely made working harder; I also think having weekly quizzes without the ability to review your answers is pretty ridiculous.
bolfarine doesnt get through whole lesson. but even if he did i dont think it would matter because there are always things on homework's or quizzes that were never brought up or explained. hard to do well when they dont teach half of what you need to know. lacking good practice for exams.
Hard to follow Bolfarine at times. Lectures were unorganized at times. Not sure why we go over r code in class and is primarily what we are taught but for the exams and quizzes you do not need to know r code. Learned most things from studying at home.
Lectures were almost entirely based on coding, where tests only focused on given outputs and interpretation (no coding)
Having all the quizzes be online and then the exams on paper, I suggest making quizzes paper as well to better get a feel for the exam
The content was difficult in the second half... go to office hours
I found the logistic regression unit to be the hardest to grasp. I think spending extra time on that unit and spending less on others would be helpful.
having homework problems being different than what we did in class. Yes, in class we learned the general topic, but the homework goes way further and class doesn't give proper preparation. In class we should do homework problems (with different numbers) so students have something to reference when doing their homework.
The exams, quizzes, and homeworks were challenging. They lacked consistent structure. The class needs to be entirely R based or entirely conceptual rather than split half and half.
Need more explanation on the subject matter.
I did not like how the quizzes during class were not open to view and how we never went over them. It felt like we were just taking

Comments
them to take them and never look at them again. They waste class time that we could be learning stuff.
The group projects were a bit off topic and did not really benefit in helping for the test
The most challenging part of the course was keeping up with the content and being ready to take the in class quizzes. If you did not feel prepared there was nothing you could do about it. I would suggest students to fully review the previous lecture and deeply understand the content to be ready for the next class.
I don't think this class was well organized because we focused on coding in class and for practice exams, homework, but on the exam, it focused more on concepts that we didn't really focus on in class, so the exam didn't really focus on what we learned and there were a lot of hard questions as well that we didn't learn. This wasn't really the professors fault because he agreed but more of a department issue. If we focused more on concepts in class and coded less it would make sense for the exam to be on paper
Prof.'s class discussions were never on the test!!!
The actual class content was a little difficult to understand, when to use what model was slightly confusing. I would suggest the professor taking a pause between sections to ensure that students are truly understanding the content.
Lectures are long
The most challenging aspect of this course was the homework assignments, particularly due to their length and the limited guidance provided. To help future students, I would suggest offering more structured examples or optional walkthrough videos to support independent learning.
The exams were sometimes harder than practice, which made it hard to do as well as I hoped.
The material at times could be a little challenging, but overall the professor was more than helpful in making sure we understood everything.